

Proposal format:

1. Examples of work can be from either the consulting firm as a whole or individuals included in the proposed team.
2. A proposal of the methodology should be included. That methodology does not need to include highly specific information, such as the type or regression that will be used, but should provide an overview of the planned methodology.
3. The contract will be awarded in May.

Report format:

4. Executive Summary: general information is preferred as this section will be the public facing section of the report.
5. Any confidential information should be included in the body of the report and not the Executive summary.
6. Either a written report with numbered pages or a PowerPoint presentation are acceptable formats for the final report.

Study Focus:

7. Econometric simulations and regressions may be utilized and included in the study as the selected vendor deems necessary.
8. Travel or an in-person visit by local consulting staff to the two schools is deemed as necessary for a robust study from USW's perspective.
9. USW is interested in both the baking program health and viability at each school, as well as the medium- to long-term viability of the host schools.
 - Both educational institutes have ties to their respective governments. Review of the governments' support and any requirements, obstacles, etc. that are part of that support should be considered.
10. There are approximately 25-30 people of interest that could be interviewed across the two markets.
11. Currently, a baking seminar is not planned for either country.

USW Data Support, Introductions:

12. U.S. Wheat Associates is willing to provide introduction letters to provide background information on the study and introduce USW as an organization.
13. USW will have a document list available for the winning consultant including, at a minimum, the following.
 - Equipment purchases, timelines and invoices for each of the two schools.
 - Instructor education timelines.
 - USW programs at the two schools in the past 20 years-including participant lists and counts, program focuses, and brief reports on each activity.
 - U.S. wheat exports to the two countries over the past twenty years.
 - Any prior documentation on the schools.
 - If the selected consultant identifies other material or background information that would assist with the evaluation, USW will endeavor to make that available to the best of its abilities.

Budget:

14. Please note the requirement to include country specific costs. This does not need to include a line-by-line budget, but the overall budget will need to be split as the selected vendor deems fit between the countries of Jamaica and the DR.

15. Budget is 20% of the overall scoring matrix. USW certainly takes the investment necessary into account when making the decision, but it is not the only factor. We do not select the lowest-cost proposal if a higher cost proposal can be justified due to more robust methodology.
16. USW may, at their own discretion, enter into a separate contract at a later date for the selected vendor to present the material at a conference. As such, conference presentation costs do not need to be included in the proposal for this study.

Travel Guidelines:

17. USW must advise USDA of any travel to countries as part of this study at least two weeks in advance. Please include lodging information (hotel name, address, and phone number) when advising USW of the travel.
18. If travel is included as part of the selected vendor's methodology, USW will hold the vendor accountable for that methodology and travel.

Timing of Final Report:

19. At USW's discretion and in negotiation with the selected vendor, the October 31, 2026, deadline for the final report could be adjusted to provide additional time for analysis if warranted.